

Scenario: A final-year CS student sends the following email to request a research rotation. She receives no response and has to send multiple follow-ups, eventually getting a meeting very late. Below is the described e-mail:

To: janesmith@university.edu

Subject: Rotation

Dear Jane Smith,

My name is Sarah and I am a final-year undergraduate student in Computer Science. I did research in the Chen Lab at Comm Lab University, studying efficient fine-tuning of large language models. I spent 2 years designing multimodal models that combine vision and text for emotion recognition. Through this work, we found result X and result Y. I enjoyed this research a lot. I am interested in studying similar topics regarding deep learning for multimodal perception for my FYP. Christopher Chen recommended your lab. Could we schedule a meeting this week to discuss a rotation in your lab?

Thanks!

Sarah

Follow-up note (no response):

Sarah has to send 2–4 follow-up emails to get a response and ultimately schedule a meeting in late October.

Task: Identify issues which resulted in 2-4 follow up e-mails from Sarah to get a response:

1. What is the main purpose of this email?	
2. Where does the purpose appear?	
3. Identify one structural issue	
4. Identify one clarity issue	
5. Identify one tone/formality issue	
6. What information is unnecessary or excessive?	
7. What would cause the professor to ignore or delay replying?	